HARDLEAF

TIMO FEDDERN, ZAN KOCUNIK, ALESSIA MARTINO
GROUP 03 / CODING ARCHITECTURE II / FS26

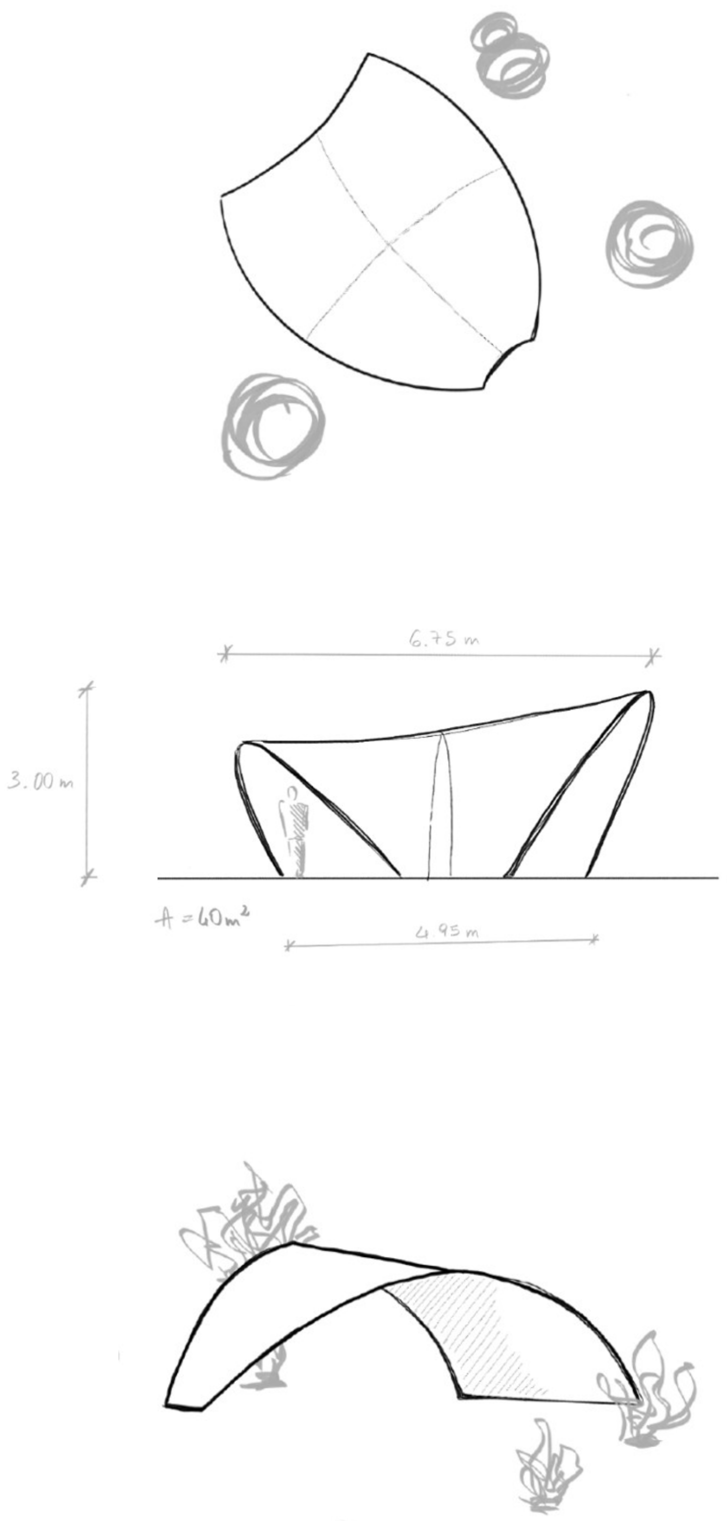
The pavilion was conceived through a design process focused on preserving and enhancing the existing vegetation of the garden. Particular attention was given to the plum tree and the banana trees, which emerged during the site visit as important and valued elements of the space. Rather than imposing a new object onto the site, the project was developed as an organic intervention integrated around the presence of these plants.

As the design evolved, the geometry was refined to maximize shaded areas and improve environmental comfort. This led to the development of a leaf-shaped configuration, characterized by variations in height and a wider canopy capable of providing extensive coverage while maintaining a projected area of 40 m². The pavilion retains a clear and simple structural logic based on two load-bearing sides: a longer structural edge positioned parallel to the existing fence at the back of the garden, and a shorter side at the front, opening the pavilion towards the landscape.

The orientation of the structure directly informs its form. On the south side, the pavilion remains lower in height to strengthen protection from direct sunlight, working together with the natural shade provided by the nearby plum tree. Towards the north, the structure gradually opens and rises, creating a lighter and more permeable spatial condition.

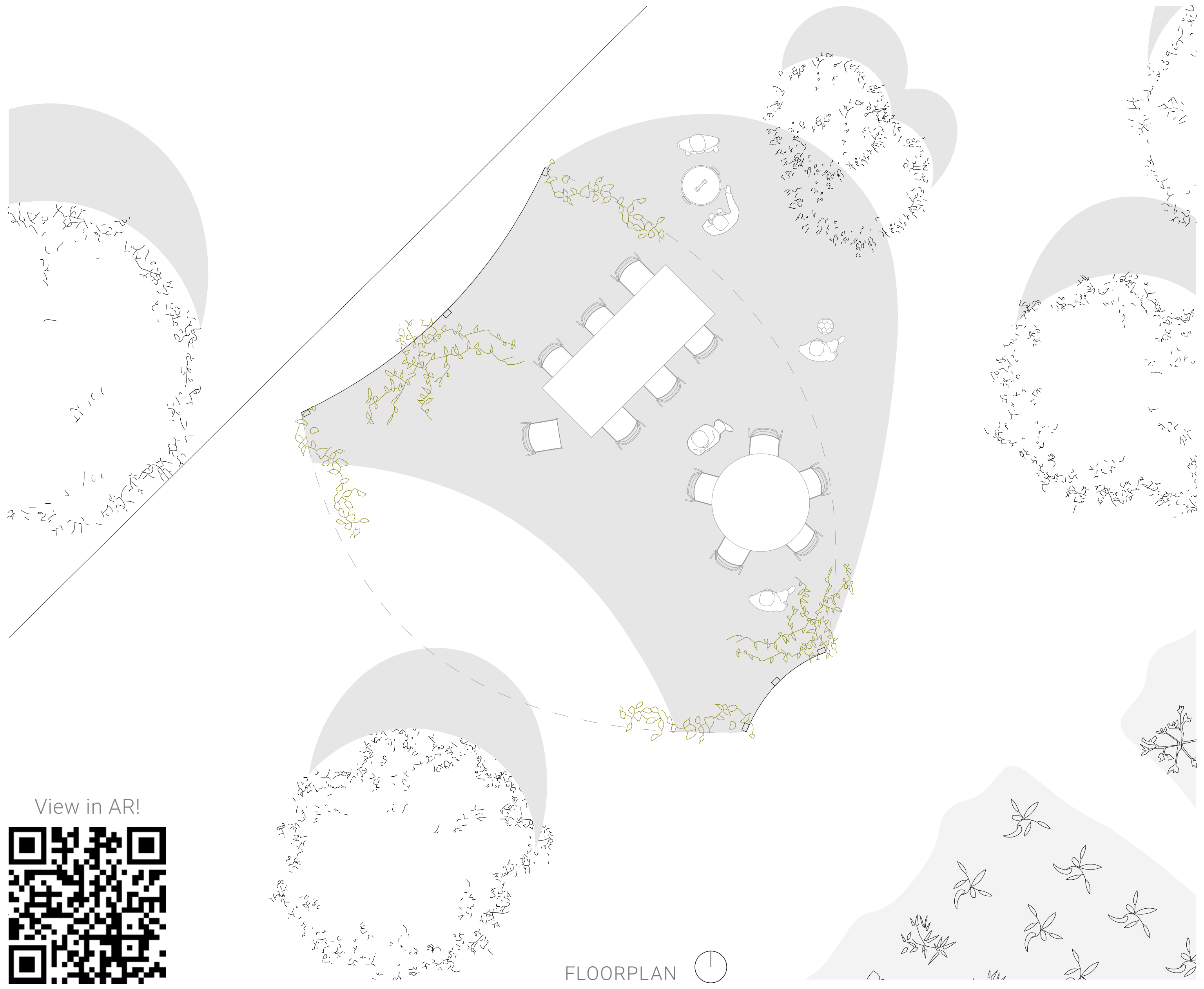
The covered area was intentionally designed as a wide and open space, ensuring flexibility and adaptability for different uses over time. The pavilion can accommodate tables, gatherings, workshops, or temporary installations, while remaining open to future transformations and changing configurations of plants within the garden.

The project also responds to the current condition of the kiwi plants located in the center of the site. Since relocating them immediately may not be possible, the pavilion allows for multiple scenarios: the plants can temporarily remain within the open interior space or later be repositioned along the structural base, where they could continue growing integrated with the pavilion itself while keeping the central area unobstructed.



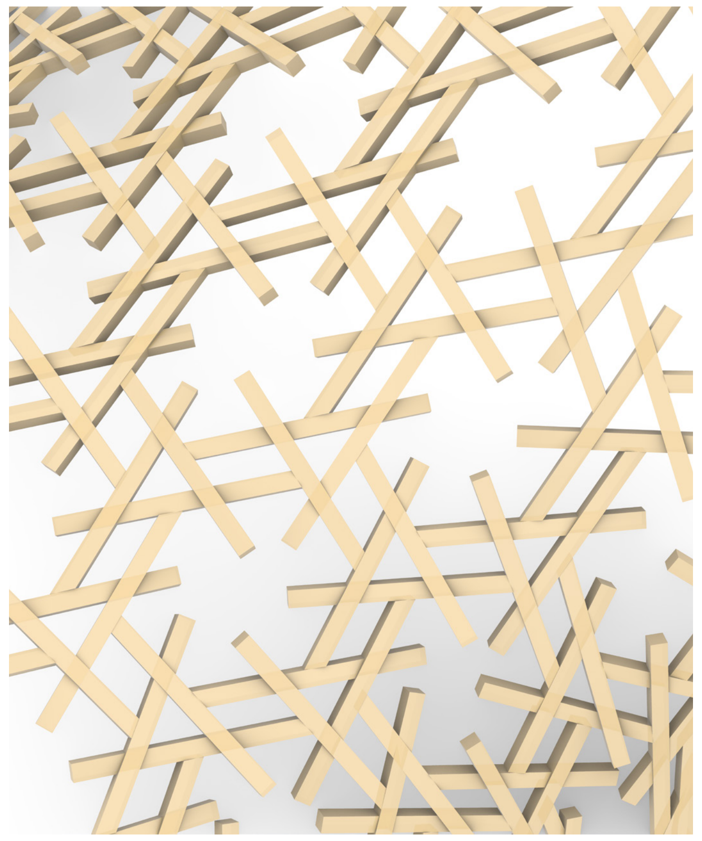
SKETCHES

QUARTIERGARTEN HARD, ZURICH

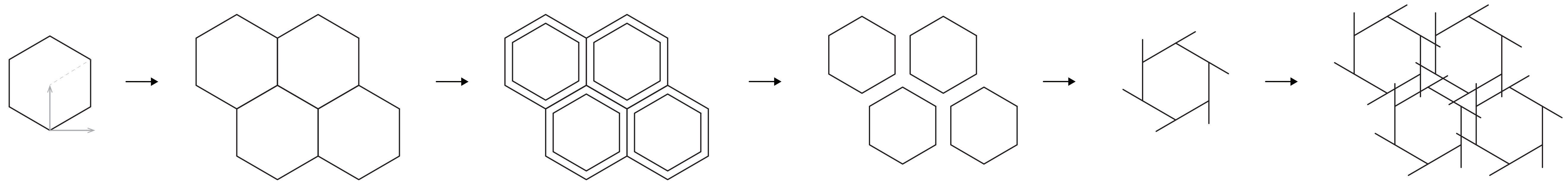


View in AR!

FLOORPLAN



The reciprocal frame structure is generated through an organic meshing system derived from a hexagonal pattern. Starting from a regular geometric grid, the mesh was progressively transformed and adapted to create a more fluid and natural configuration. The resulting network combines order and irregularity: the hexagonal geometry provides structural continuity and stability, while the variation in orientation and density creates a lighter, more dynamic spatial effect. The differentiated density of the mesh also allows the structure to accommodate multiple configurations of hanging plants and climbing vegetation, creating areas with varying levels of shade, openness, and interaction with the surrounding garden.



MESHING WORKFLOW